CoachOS: Pricing & Business Strategy

Executive summary

CoachOS aims to disrupt the Indian Coaching ERP market with a very low entry price (₹99/month) while keeping infrastructure costs controlled so every customer remains profitable. The strategy is:

- **Start with an impulse-buy price** (₹99) to maximize adoption.
- **Use caps + fair-usage nudges** (students, storage, messages) to drive upgrades naturally.
- **Decouple variable costs** (WhatsApp/SMS) via a wallet so messaging can never turn the ₹99 plan into a loss.
- **Keep support and infra efficient** (self-serve + cost-optimized backend).
- **Offer a 14-day trial** so institutes can experience the convenience and power before paying.

Market positioning: the “Disruptor”

Indian coaching owners are price-sensitive but value-conscious.

- **Problem:** Competitors (e.g., Classplus) often have setup fees or opaque pricing.
- **Solution:** A transparent, pay-as-you-grow model that starts at **₹99**, making the decision easy.

Pricing & limits (Disruptor model)

Feature	Aarambh (Entry)	Pragati (Pro)	Utsav (Enterprise)
Monthly price	**₹99**	**₹499**	**₹1,999+**
Billed yearly	₹1,188 + GST	₹5,988 + GST	₹23,988+ + GST
Student cap	**40**	**300**	**Unlimited**
Batch cap	3	10	Unlimited

Feature	Aarambh (Entry)	Pragati (Pro)	Utsav (Enterprise)
Storage cap	250 MB (optimized)	5 GB	50 GB+
WhatsApp / SMS	**Pay-as-you-go**	500 free / month	2,000 free / month
Core ERP	All ERP	All ERP + staff+its payroll	All ERP + multi institute dashboard analytics
Analytics	Basic	Advanced	Multi-institute
Support	Help center / bot	Priority WhatsApp	Dedicated manager

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Wallet system (variable-cost protection)

WhatsApp and SMS have direct third-party costs. To prevent losses, CoachOS uses a **wallet system** for:

- **Aarambh (₹99)** plan messaging
- Any messaging above **Pro/Enterprise** included limits

Top-ups (illustrative):

- **Mini:** ₹100 → ~300 credits (≈ ₹0.33/msg)
- **Standard:** ₹500 → ~1,650 credits (≈ ₹0.30/msg)
- **Bulk:** ₹1,000 → ~3,500 credits (≈ ₹0.28/msg)

> **Principle:** Messaging is always a pass-through cost. Users pay for what they consume.

Why this works (India-first logic)

1. **Low psychological barrier (₹99):** Easier to say “yes” than almost any SaaS tool.
2. **Natural upgrade path (300 students):** Most mid-sized coaching centers will outgrow 40 students and land in the ₹499 tier (primary margin driver).
3. **Fair-usage nudges:** Student and storage caps push upgrades at the exact moment the institute is earning enough to afford it.

4. **Zero-loss guarantee:** No bundled messages on the ₹99 plan prevents notification abuse.

“Pocket Shield” margin protection

A) Communication infrastructure

- ₹99 plan includes **0 bundled messages**
- Wallet system prevents high-volume usage from turning into losses

B) Storage optimization

- **Auto-squash:** Compress images heavily (e.g., ~80%) on upload
- **Fair purge:** Let institutes delete old batch data to reclaim space

C) Support model

- Aarambh users: AI-first support + documentation
- Higher tiers: priority + dedicated support as a value add

Worst-case survival strategy

If growth is slow, CoachOS stays sustainable via:

1. **Low-burn infrastructure:** Auto-scaling compute that drops during off-peak hours.
2. **Upfront cash flow:** Yearly billing provides early liquidity for servers + marketing.
3. **High switching cost:** Once student and fee data lives in CoachOS, churn reduces.

Business guardrails

- **GST protection:** Prices are quoted **exclusive of GST**.
- **Hard-stop limits:** Automatically block student creation when limits are reached.
- **Trial-first conversion:** 14-day trial so users can experience the product’s convenience and power; no refunds after activation.

Conclusion

CoachOS wins by being the **“Xiaomi of Coaching SaaS”**: enterprise-grade capabilities at a price point that feels impossible—backed by cost-optimized infrastructure and fair-usage economics that keep profitability intact from day one.

This pricing strategy is **battle-ready** for the Indian market because it solves the "Commitment Phobia" that most Indian coaching owners have. By offering a ₹99 entry point, you aren't selling software; you're selling a **digital habit.**

Here is a deep-dive audit of the limits and why they will succeed or where they might face friction:

1. Small Independent Tutor (The "Aarambh" Plan - ₹99)

- **The Logic**: A tutor with 40 students in India typically earns between ₹15,000 to ₹40,000 per month. Paying ₹99 is less than **0.5% of their revenue**. It’s an "impulse buy."
- **The Limits (40 Students / 3 Batches)**:
  - **Success Factor**: Most home-tutors teach 2-3 grades (e.g., 9th, 10th, and 12th). The 3-batch limit is perfect. It allows them to organize their core work without feeling restricted.
  - **The Nudge**: The moment they hit 41 students, they are officially "growing." The jump to ₹499 happens exactly when they can afford it.
- **Risk**: If they teach 5 subjects to the same 20 students, they might hit the 3-batch limit quickly.
  - *Strategy*: We should encourage them to use "Subject" fields within a batch rather than creating new batches for every subject.

2. Mid-Size Tuition Classes (The "Pragati" Plan - ₹499)

- **The Logic**: This is your "Profit Engine." A center with 100-300 students is a "proper business" with a physical office and staff. ₹499/month is negligible for them—it’s roughly the cost of 5-10 WhatsApp messages per student.
- **The Limits (300 Students / 10 Batches)**:

    - **Success Factor**: 300 students is the "ceiling" for most local coaching centers before they need multiple branches or a massive hall.
    - **Storage (5GB)**: For ERP (text/receipts/photos), 5GB is **massive**. It will last them 3-4 years, which builds long-term retention. They won't leave because "all my data is there and it's not full yet."
- **The Nudge**: The **10-batch limit** is the secret weapon here. A center with 300 students across 5 grades and 4 subjects will have 20+ batches. This limit will naturally push mid-size centers toward the **Enterprise Plan** even if they don't have 1,000 students.

3. Large Institutes (The "Utsav" Plan - ₹1,999+)

- **The Logic**: Large hubs care about **Brand** and **Control**. They want their own name on the SMS, their own subdomain, and multi-branch tracking.
- **The Limits (Unlimited)**:
    - **Success Factor**: Compared to competitors who charge ₹15,000 to ₹50,000 for "Enterprise" versions, ₹1,999/month is a "no-brainer" deal.
    - **Storage (50GB+)**: This is essential for institutes that want to upload study materials (LMS).

Why this succeeds at "Survival at Worst":

1. **The "Teesta" (Frictionless) Onboarding**: By quoting ₹99, you compete with "Free" apps. Once they put their student data in, the **Switching Cost** becomes very high. They won't leave for a cheaper app because there isn't one.
2. **Wallet System is the MVP**: By not bundling WhatsApp in the ₹99 plan, you avoid the #1 cause of SaaS failure in India: **Third-party API bills.** You are essentially a "Pre-paid" service. You only spend money when the user gives you money.
3. **Self-Correction**: If a user is "Abusing" the storage, the 250MB limit on the ₹99 plan stops them. It forces a conversation or an upgrade before it hits your pocket.

Final Verdict:

This strategy is **highly likely to succeed** because it respects the "Indian Scale." It allows a tutor to start for the price of a *samosa-chai* party and grow into a professional institute without ever feeling cheated.

One Small Suggestion: Keep the "Aarambh" plan as **₹99 + GST**. This protects your margin and sets a professional expectation that this is a B2B service.